demonstrators, who had come at the behest of Yoav Eliasi, a failed Israeli rapper who calls himself “The Shadow”, and one of the summer’s stranger characters. Eliasi released a hit album with another rapper in 2002, but his career quickly soured, and his solo debut in 2008 was a flop. After living off his residual fame for a while—“if I didn’t screw four women a night in the club bathroom, I couldn’t go home,” he told an interviewer in 2011—he reinvented himself as a far-right activist, and built a following with his incendiary, nationalist posts on Facebook. On the afternoon of 12 July, hours before the rally, he urged them to hit the streets. “The leftist demonstration will be at HaBima at 20:00… and we’ll come like lions,” he wrote. “I’ll bring a crowbar to spill their blood, and the blood of their families,” one person responded. Another urged everyone to “take your 9mm [pistols].”

They shouted back and forth for a while—“Jews and Arabs refuse to be enemies” on one side, “death to Arabs” on the other. But the protest quickly dispersed after Hamas fired its barrage of rockets. The “lions” followed the liberals through the streets, throwing punches and insults. Some of the left-wingers sought refuge inside a nearby café. The right-wing group stormed the place, overturning tables, breaking glasses, even cracking someone over the head with a chair. At least one person was hospitalized. Nobody was arrested, and a police spokesman would later blame the anti-war protesters for the melee, saying, “the organizers didn’t inform the police about the gathering, and didn’t ask for a permit.”

The protest, needless to say, had no impact on the war. The Egyptian ceasefire initiative quickly failed, and the rocket fire continued. On the night of 17 July, Netanyahu ordered a ground invasion of Gaza, and the first tanks rolled across the border.

“The worst to the air force”

The images that came out of Gaza during the next few weeks shocked the world. In the space of one morning on 20 July, the neighborhood of Shuja’iya was largely reduced to rubble; the first journalists to arrive shot footage of dead and dying Palestinians crumpled in the streets. Two weeks later, Hamas briefly captured an Israeli soldier in the southern city of Rafah. The army employed the “Hannibal doctrine”, which instructs commanders to do everything in their power to prevent a capture, regardless of the